AFFORDABLE AND CLEAN ENERGY

STATE CAPACITY, POLITICAL GOODS, AND ENERGY TRANSITIONS: A COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS OF SDG 7 IN BANGLADESH AND JAPAN

Understanding SDG 7 Outcomes through State Formation and Policy (2000–2021)

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1. INTRODUCTION

- SDG 7 aims for universal access to affordable, reliable, sustainable, and modern energy.
- State capacity to provide political goods is key to translating global goals into domestic policy.
- Using a Most Different Systems Design (MDSD), this study separates the influence of various state capacities on public service delivery.

2. RESEARCH QUESTION

- What is the reason why Bangladesh and Japan have such opposite SDG 7 results even though both countries are pledged to sustainable development?

3.LITERATURE REVIEW

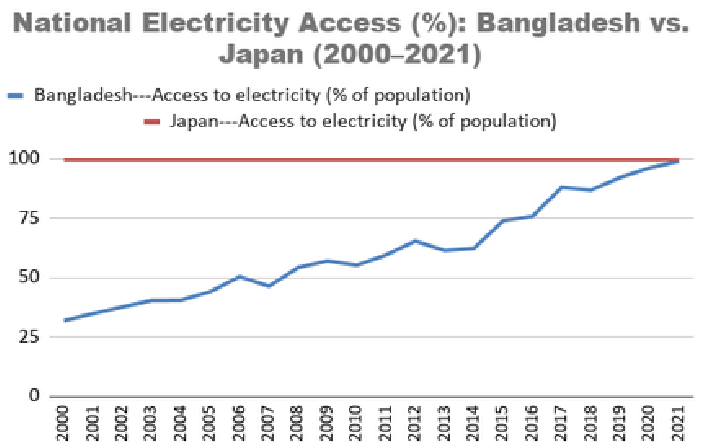
- **Comparative method** as an alternative to experimental (Lijphart, 1971).
- **Global legacies and state formation determine capacity (Wallerstein, 1974;** Lange, 2012). Strong vs. weak state provision of political goods (Rotberg, 2003).
- **Institutionalism:** Formal/informal rules, path dependency. Bureaucratic inertia.
- **Political-Economy:** Power and resource distribution. Iron Triangle in Japan vs. donor influence in Bangladesh.
- **rapid progress** via carbon-reliant hardware for political gains vs. decentralized software needed for clean cooking **(Sovacool et al., 2020)**

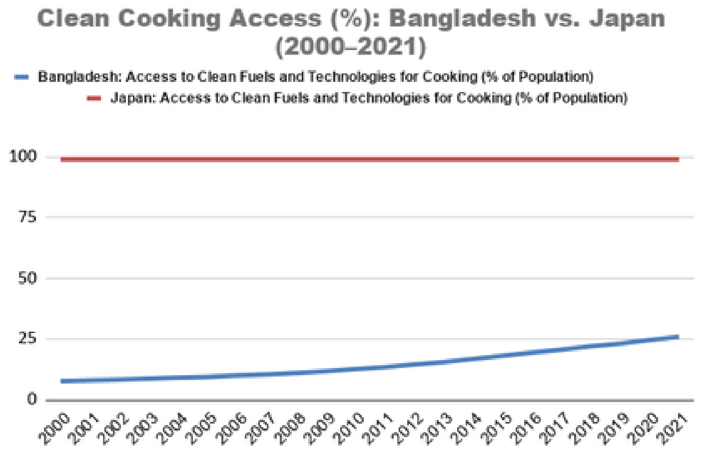
4. Empirical Trajectories (World Bank Analysis)

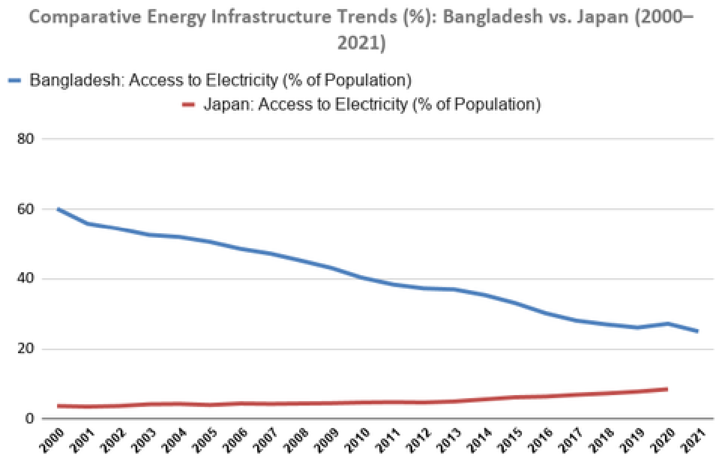
Kaufmann (2010): Governance → Infrastructure quality.

WDR (2017): Regulation → SDG 6 & 11 success.

Jayachandran (2015): Institutions → Gender equity.







5.DATA ANALYSIS

(SDG 7 Indicators, 2000–2021)

Bangladesh achieved stunned 99.5% (2023) access through massive top-down grid expansion.

Progress stagnated at ~28%, reflecting institutional barriers to localised regulation and behavioural change.

Illustrative an illustrative trend for conflicting, Japan with low growth, lagged, and Bangladesh suppressed for fossil fuels

6.KEY FINDINGS

- BP 1: Japan is a strong state ensuring the smooth delivery of infrastructural goods.
- BP 2: Bangladesh effective at large-scale top-down hardware, ineffective at localized regulatory software.
- BP 2: State capacity is highly asymmetrical across indicators.

7.LIMITATIONS

- **BP1 (Regional):** Hardware prioritizes immediate political gains via carbon-intensive fuels, creating regional disparities.
- **BP2 (Rural):** Stagnant "software" means localized regulation and behavior change remain steep hurdles in rural areas.
- **BP3 (Education):** Progress hides failures (e.g., 99.5% electricity but 28% clean cooking access), indicating a need for better educational interventions

8.FUTURE WORKS

- **Study decentralized state capacity and behavioral intervention.**
- **Investigate the impact of donor funding and fossil fuel priorities on renewable markets.**
- **Examine path dependency within Japan's Iron Triangle.**

9. REFERENCES

- **Kaufmann (2010): WGI Governance Indicators & State Effectiveness.**
- **World Bank (2017): WDR – Governance, Law, and SDG Trajectories.**
- **Sovacool (2020): Energy Transition "Hardware" vs. "Software."**